> shewing me respect was unreasonable, since it was for this (Tīmūrid) dynasty's sake I had thus fought and striven with that alien foe.

After Babur expressed his displeasure, they admitted to having committed the mistake of not honouring Babur enough and began to shower all the due respect at once. After a couple of days, when Babur visited Badī'u'z-zamān Mīrzā after the mid-day prayer, an elegant wine feast was in progress. Along with multiple variants of wine, brochettes of goose and fowl, and all kinds of viands were set on perfect table linen. Mīrzā's wine parties and entertainment activities were very known. Babur chose not to drink even a drop of wine at this event. He has mentioned in the *Baburnama* that no one pressured him to drink—it could simply mean that, in general, people would insist on non-drinkers consuming alcohol.

Finally, after three months, the Mīrzās agreed mutually to set out of Herī with troops and reach Murghāb. It was heard that Sulṭān Qul-i-nachāq had crossed the extremes of being passive. He had surrendered Balkh[19] to the Aūzbegs. But as soon as that very Aūzbeg heard of Babur and other alliance of Mīrzās marching against him, he rushed away to Samarkand.

In the meantime, Babur was finding the Mīrzās to not be as good fighters as they were as good for parties.[*]

> The Mīrzās were good enough as company and in social matters, in conversation and parties, but they were strangers to war, strategy, equipment, bold fight and encounter.

Now, while Babur and Mīrzās were on the Murghāb, the message came that Ḥaq-naẓīr Chapā along with his half a thousand men was invading the vicinity of Chīchīk-tū. But to their pity, Mīrzās couldn't send even the lightest of troops to defend this invasion of raiders. This must be noted that the distance between Murghāb and Chīchīk-tū was just around fifty-five miles. Babur has asserted in *Baburnama* that though he wanted to lead at this point, he wasn't given the opportunity.[†]

> I asked the work; they, with a thought for their own reputation, would not give it to me.

Almost a year had passed since Shaybāni Khān had retired. Winter was knocking at the door. The Mīrzās decided to it at a convenient place and from where they could congregate again in the coming summers with the mission to deter their enemy.

The Mīrzās tried to persuade Babur to pass the winters in Khurāsān. But both Kābul and Ghaznī were now full of people with ill temperament, who only